

CONTEXT

- Transit agencies manage critical information such as service alerts, routes, schedules, stops, and disruptions.
- Riders depend on timely and reliable service information to plan trips and avoid surprises.
- The product opportunity is to help agencies maintain alert quality throughout the full lifecycle, not just create alerts faster.

PROBLEM

- Transit agencies experience operational complexity when managing service alerts manually.
- The alert lifecycle - creation, publishing, monitoring, updating, extending, and closing - depends heavily on staff follow-up.
- As alert volume grows, teams can miss alerts that need review, alerts nearing expiration, or alerts that should already be closed.
- Outdated rider-facing information can reduce trust and create confusion for daily commuters.

USERS

- Agency communications officer: creates and updates alerts under time pressure and is accountable for accuracy.
- Daily rider: checks transit information before leaving and expects the service status to be current.
- Account manager: supports agencies after onboarding and needs the product to be simple and scalable.

WHY THIS FEATURE WON

- Alert Lifecycle Manager ranked highest in RICE because it directly solves the core lifecycle maintenance problem.
- It scored higher than an AI alert-writing assistant because the main issue was not only creating alerts; it was keeping already-published alerts accurate.
- It scored higher than an insights dashboard because it gives staff an action queue, not only reporting.
- The feature helps staff identify which alerts require review, update, extension, or closure before riders encounter stale information.

SOLUTION

- The feature provides a centralized review queue for active alerts.
- It highlights alerts that are healthy, need review, are expiring soon, or may be

Outdated.

- Staff can quickly review, update, extend, or close alerts from one workflow.
- The experience reduces manual monitoring and improves rider-facing information quality.

SUCCESS METRICS

- North Star Metric: percentage of active alerts that remain accurate and up to date throughout their lifecycle.
- Initiative Metric: percentage of alerts reviewed, updated, or closed before becoming outdated.
- Reduce outdated active alerts by 50%.
- Increase alerts reviewed before expiration from 40% to 80%.
- Reduce rider complaints related to inaccurate service alerts.

IMPACT

- Improves information accuracy by surfacing alerts requiring attention.
- Improves operational efficiency by reducing manual monitoring effort.
- Improves scalability as alert volume grows.
- Improves rider experience by keeping service information current and trustworthy.
- Expands product value from alert creation to alert quality management.

ROLLOUT

- Pilot with 2-3 existing transit agencies and monitor alert review rates.
- Move to general availability with onboarding guides and product walkthroughs.
- Optimize with smart recommendations, alert analytics, collaboration workflows, and expanded reporting.

WHAT I LEARNED

- The highest-impact opportunity is not always the most visible feature.
- Activity metrics such as number of alerts created are weaker than outcome metrics such as lifecycle accuracy.
- A strong operational product should reduce hidden manual work while improving the user-facing experience.